



UQFC - U9-U13 - Playing Through Midfield - Session 1

Category: Academy: Playing through the thirds

Difficulty: Moderate

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Description

Principle: Playing Through Midfield

Behaviours: Play through or around opposition to progress the ball forwards

Moments:

As our defender drives into midfield

When we have possession in the midfield

4v2 Rondo (20 mins)

Rondo 4v2/4v1 (adjust numbers)

Area - Diamond shape (10x10m)

Time - 3 x 4 minutes with 2 x 30-second Dual Force exercises between sets

Action - Playing Through

Behaviour - Finding space to connect and play forward

Rules:

- Defenders hold bibs and drop when they retain the ball or are
- closest to the player that kicks it outside the area
- If a defender drops the bib outside the area or throws it, and
- the new defender catches it, they are in again
- Defenders steal the ball, drop the bib and play. Any defender
- kicking the ball out remains a defender
- Players restart/collect balls from ball stations

Progression: (after 4-minute set)

- 10 passes and catch to keep defenders in for another round
- Defenders can win the ball and drive out the square

Dual Force - First Round

- Side pushes, in twos players go shoulder to shoulder and push their partner sideways three steps to gain a point, changing sides after each point (30 seconds)
- Side pushes 2, players can now select any player/s to side push out the area to gain a point (30 seconds)
- Football actions only when side pushing players

Dual Force - Second Round

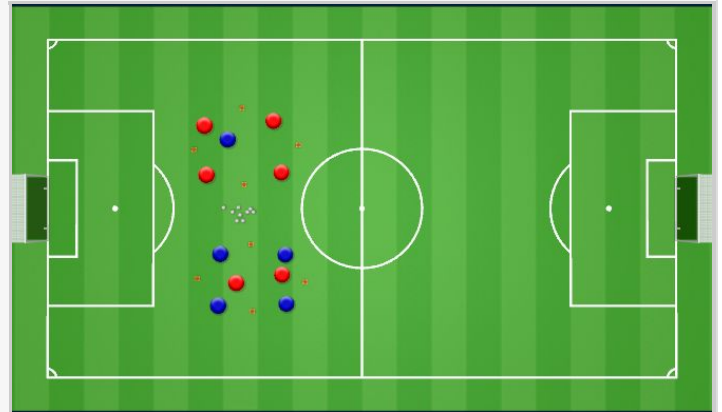
- In threes one player, puts a bib down the back of their shorts (hanging out) and faces his partner, placing hands on each other's shoulders, they use their partner to defend the third player who is trying to steal the bib, players change roles once the bib is taken

Coaching:

- Observe players finding space inside
- Observe player profiles to play forward effectively

Water Break:

Duration 4-minutes



Rondo - Transfer (25 mins)

Positioning Game - 4v4+4 (Generic)

Area - Rectangle shape (25x20m)

Time - 3 sets of 7, 6, and 5 minutes with two-minute rest in between

Action - Playing Through

Behaviour - Finding space to connect and play forward

Rules:

- Play the ball from one neutral (red) to another for a point to the team in possession.
- Once a team find a player at one end, they try and find the player on the other end for a point
- End player reposition (find the ball) along the whole end line
- Swap neutrals (aka teams) after each round.
- Get teams to add up points and see who is the winner at the end

Progression:

- 5v5+2
- Place a member of each team on each end (6v6)

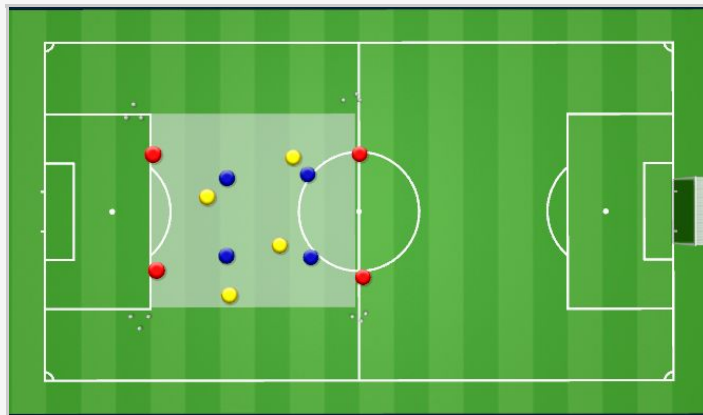
Coaching: Ask Questions

- Team task, can we play through to the end player effectively?
- Task players to find the ball inside (passing lanes) to play through and aim to connect the neutrals.
- Rope analogy - we are all connected by rope and the defenders are scissors, constantly **Repositioning** yourself to be able to receive the ball and play your next pass.
- **Over - Through - Beside - Behind** sequential thought processing.

Water Break:

Drinks after all three sets are completed

Select a few players to demonstrate their correct profile to play forward quickly



Game (30 mins)

Training Game 5v5

Area - 35 yards by 20 yards

Time - 2 x 13 minute halves with a 2-minute break

Focus - Playing through midfield

Set ups - 2-1-2

Rules:

- Players score into each big goals
- Play through the central yellow area

Coaching:

- Observe players finding space in the central area (passing line)
- Reinforce the rope analogy.
- Is their profile correct to play forward quickly and effectively?

Ask questions to the players and reinforce why want to play through the opposition.

